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Purpose

This policy explains who owns the work that employees create and how it is protected.

Scope

This document applies to employees based in Germany. It is owned by Joseph Coleman and is effective from 2026-01-02.

Policy Rules

Work created as part of a job belongs to the company.

Open-source code may only be used if the licence is on the approved list.

Inventions must be reported to legal within 30 days of being conceived.

Company logos and brand assets may only be used following the brand guidelines.

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Procedure

1. Describe the invention or work in the IP disclosure form.
2. Send the form to the legal team.
3. Legal assesses whether a patent or copyright filing is useful.
4. Legal confirms the decision to the inventor.

Escalation

Suspected misuse of company IP is reported to legal immediately.

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Contacts

Send questions about this document by email to legal-help@company.local.

Document Control

Under Intellectual Property Policy (Germany) (version 3), the standard limit is 90 days.
This is the maximum number of days between two checks of the document by its owner.

Version 3 replaces version 2. Values and thresholds were revised in the latest yearly check.